Global Health (research)

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam - Faculty of Science - Global Health (research) - 2025-2026

During the Research Master Global Health, students from all over the world embark on an intensive study of cross-cutting aspects of health problems and health systems. Students develop insight into specific topics, such as infectious diseases, non-communicable diseases, child and maternal health, and mental health in Master Classes, and learn about interdisciplinary and transdisciplinary approaches to meeting complex health-related challenges.

Students develop the knowledge and skills to use a wide range of qualitative and quantitative research methods. Special attention is given to developing students' ability to critically assess research designs and research proposals. Students are taught how to design, implement, and measure the impact of interventions that address complex health challenges, and how to analyse and compare different health systems. Building on systems thinking and research that combines and transcends individual disciplines, the programme offers an intensive study of multiple aspects of health systems and factors involved in health, including the burden of disease, finance, regulatory mechanisms, power constellations, social determinants of health, and change management.

Info

Level	Master
Language	English
Duration	2 years
Type	Full Time
Credits	120 EC
Faculty	Faculty of Science

Teaching and examination regulation 2025-2026
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Global Health year 1

Description

In the first year of the programme, you will focus on the study of complex global health problems in high- and low-income countries. You will learn how to analyse problems, design intervention strategies and measure the effectiveness of such strategies using qualitative and quantitative research methods involving multiple stakeholders and perspectives. You will also learn how to study health problems and interventions in the broader context of national health systems and to compare these between countries. You will then focus on your scientific writing skills and conduct a literature review. During your academic year you will also benefit from a professional development programme covering skills you need for success in the diverse Global Health field.

The curriculum includes four core courses, an elective course and a mixed-methods research internship in the Netherlands. or abroad.

Programme Sections

- Global Health year 1 compulsory courses
- Global Health constrained choice

Global Health year 1 compulsory courses

Description

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Students develop the knowledge and skills to use a wide range of qualitative and quantitative research methods. Special attention is given to developing students' ability to critically assess research designs and research proposals. Students are taught how to design, implement and measure the impact of interventions that address complex health challenges, and how to analyse and compare different health systems. Building on systems thinking and research that combines and transcends individual disciplines, the programme offers an intensive study of multiple aspects of health systems and factors involved in health, including the burden of disease, finance, regulatory mechanisms, power constellations, social determinants of health, and change management.

Course registration

Admission to the Research Master Global Health is possible for an applicant who has a Bachelor’s degree obtained at an institution of academic higher education, which demonstrates knowledge, understanding and skills covered in health or social sciences. Examples of Bachelor’s degrees in disciplines linked to Global Health include Medical Biology, Health Sciences, (International) Public Health, (Medical) Anthropology or Sociology, Medicine, Health Economics, Health Management, Pharmacy, Psychology, Nursing, Public Policy, Rehabilitation Sciences and Disability Studies. Basic knowledge of epidemiology and/or statistics (equivalent to at least 6 ECs) is required. Deficiency in the knowledge of both Epidemiology and Statistics can be compensated by taking additional courses (before the commencement of the study).

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Global Health Interventions	P1	6EC	AM_1176
Research Methods in Global Health	P1	6EC	AM_1175
Academic Writing for Global Health	P2	6EC	AM_1247
International Comparative Analyses of Health Care Systems	P2	6EC	AM_470820
Research Project Global Health	P4+5+6	30EC	AM_1102

Global Health constrained choice

Description

Choose 1 6EC module from following list.

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Disability and Development	P3	6EC	AM_470588
Figure It Out	P3	6EC	AM_1271
Global Mental Health	P3	6EC	AMU_0034
Materialities in Practice	P3	6EC	AMU_0028
Nutrition and Infectious Disease	P3	6EC	AM_470816
Sex, Reproduction and Development	P3	6EC	AMU_0029

Global Health year 2

Description

In the second year, you will take two courses on advanced quantitative analysis methods and transdisciplinary research. You will also focus on how to study health problems and interventions in the broader context of governmental policy, and gain an understanding of human rights and ethical issues that impact global health research and practice. Following the compulsory courses, you will choose from electives offered by Research Masters partners at the VU, UvA and AIGHD.

During the programme you will also benefit from an ongoing professional development track, helping you to develop the skills you need to work in a diverse and complex Global Health working environment.

The Master's programme is rounded off with the Master's thesis, in which you present the research findings from your second internship in a scientific article and accompanying portfolio.

Programme Sections

- Global Health year 2 compulsory courses
- Global Health constrained choice

Global Health year 2 compulsory courses

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Addressing Disease Burden in a Global Context	P1	6EC	AM_1045
Advanced Methodology ILA in Global Health	P1	6EC	AM_1044
Governance for Global Health	P2	6EC	AM_1177
Health, Globalisation and Human Rights	P2	6EC	AM_470818
Global Health Master Thesis	P4+5+6	30EC	AM_1116

Global Health constrained choice

Description
Choose 1 6EC module from following list.

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Disability and Development	P3	6EC	AM_470588
Figure It Out	P3	6EC	AM_1271
Global Mental Health	P3	6EC	AMU_0034
Materialities in Practice	P3	6EC	AMU_0028
Nutrition and Infectious Disease	P3	6EC	AM_470816
Sex, Reproduction and Development	P3	6EC	AMU_0029

Courses

Academic Writing for Global Health

Course Code	AM_1247
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.M. Waltz
Examiner	dr. M.M. Waltz
Teaching Staff	dr. M.M. Waltz, dr. G.A. Dreschler, dr. A. Martonfi
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Study Group

Course Objective

The overall goal of this course is to provide students with the knowledge and skills to conduct a literature review that is methodologically rigorous and scientifically relevant to advancing Global Health research.

1. To understand the different types of literature reviews, its uses and its importance in synthesising academic literature.
2. To develop apply the skills to conduct a literature review by executing a systematic literature search, selecting relevant articles, and preparing data extraction.
3. To evaluate the quality of scientific works using various quality assessment techniques and tools.
4. To analyse and synthesise academic and grey literature using qualitative or quantitative methods.
5. To communicate the processes and outcomes of a literature review to academic and general audiences.
6. To become confident writers of academic texts in English, where literature reviews are: a) coherent, b) convincing, c) compact and d) linguistically correct.

Course Content

Academic literature reviews are an informative synthesis of a particular topic, requiring critical reading skills to understand and succinctly interpret vast amounts of scientific literature. A critical assessment of academic texts requires a research question, systematic search strategies, data extraction and analysis techniques and an evaluative approach to quality assessment and synthesis of findings. Literature reviews are essential for Global Health as they inform future research, practices, policy and decision-making in all levels of society.

This course will provide you with the necessary skills to conduct a literature review on a Global Health-related topic. Throughout this course, you will learn the steps to conduct literature reviews and produce a review on current emerging Global Health issues in partnership with an internal or external commissioner. This course will also be combined with Scientific Writing Skills workshops to provide practical, hands-on experience with academic writing.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures: A maximum of two lectures (1.45 hrs each) will be delivered weekly. In these sessions, lecturers will spend the first half of the session outlining specific steps to conduct a literature review and the latter half of the lecture will be dedicated to student practice. *Attendance is required.*

Scientific Writing Workshops: A maximum of four workshops (1.45 hrs each) will be delivered throughout the course. These workshops are intended to provide students with the knowledge and skills to write a literature review. *Attendance is required.*

Method of Assessment

The final grade consists of 3 parts:

- Pass/Fail - Introduction and methods section to assess scientific writing
- 80% - Full literature review (summary of sub-assignments 1-4)
- 20% - Individual discussion and conclusion
- Pass/Fail - Participation in mandatory components of the course

A grade of 5.5 or higher (or Pass in case of pass/fail assignment) is required for each assessment.

Entry Requirements

Successfully completed Research Methods in Global Health

Literature

Reading materials for this course will be provided on Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

First-year students enrolled in the MSc Global Health (Research)

Additional Information

Obligatory course for students enrolled in the MSc Global Health (Research). This course is only open to students in this programme.

Explanation Canvas

Course information and documents will be available on Canvas.

Recommended background knowledge

Research Methods in Global Health

Addressing Disease Burden in a Global Context

Course Code	AM_1045
Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	600
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. A.H.A. ten Asbroek
Examiner	dr. A.H.A. ten Asbroek
Teaching Staff	dr. D. Brals, dr. A.H.A. ten Asbroek
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Study Group

Course Objective

In this course, current status and theories within the global health field regarding the Global Burden of Disease are introduced in lectures. This will be followed by in-depth lectures on specific topics delivered by a group of researchers from a wide range of research topics.

Also in this course, during work group sessions, you will continue with the Learning Track Research Methods: Quantitative research. For this you will need to have installed "R" on your personal laptop, which you will need to bring along during the work group sessions.

The student acquires knowledge and insight into:

- Disease burden in different parts of the world and its drivers
- Cause and effect of co-morbidity and double burden of disease.
- Medical, social, cultural and economic factors that play a role in co-morbidity and the double burden of disease
- Health systems’ responses to different burdens

The student learns

- To study different cases of (co-)morbidity in different cultures and countries
- To apply epidemiological methods for investigating and managing disease outbreaks
- To be aware and critical of their own actions, thinking and decision-making (including self-reflection on their role as a researcher in transdisciplinary research)
- To be solution-oriented
- To reflect ethically on responsibilities regarding the implementation of interventions

Course Content

Low-income countries are confronted with a growing burden of chronic, non-infectious disorders and concurrently have a high incidence of infectious diseases: the double disease burden. The interrelationship between some infections and chronic disease has been well-established.

These patterns of increasing co-morbidity and chronic diseases has a significant impact on public health, health systems and economic development.

In the first week of the course, the focus will be on understanding the concepts of Burden of Disease – building on the content of the lecture from year 1. We will use the book *Factfulness* and materials from the global burden of disease study from IHME as guiding perspectives to orient ourselves in a general way. The students will work on models for determinants of health that they then use to further explore the disease burden in a specific population.

In the second week we will have a more thematic approach to the burden of disease. We will address the burden of non-communicable disease world-wide, and what the specific challenges are in the context of urbanization. Also, we will consider the burden of infectious diseases, from control of infectious diseases in general to the burden of zoonoses and antimicrobial drug resistance in particular. As a special topic, we include a session on burden of critical care in low resource settings.

During the third week we spend time on work done in Africa on HIV and mental health, and how we as researchers can develop our tool kit for such quantitative studies. During this week you will also work on assignments in sub-groups. The topic of the assignment is to develop the data collection tool kit for studying a particular phenomenon for an epidemiological study in the area of HIV in Africa. Also, you will deepen your knowledge with a journal club in which you read and present assigned articles to each other.

The fourth week is reserved for self study, and two written exams and a presentation: one on quantitative methods, and one take-home exam (and presentation) on the content of the first two weeks.

Students will individually need to allocate time for self-study as well as sub-group time to acquire the knowledge needed to accomplish the assignments during the course.

The different activities are indicated in the calendar.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures, work groups, R practicals, problem-based learning, self-study, self-managed group work

PLEASE NOTE: In the quantitative research methods sub-track, an analysis assignment was handed out at the end of Module 2 in year 1, after which the student had 3 months to do the analysis. At the start of Module 3 the student will receive feedback, including 2 grades: a current grade and a grade they could achieve if they adjust the analysis based on the feedback they received. During Module 3, the student gets the chance to update the analysis, and 4 weeks after the start of Module 3 (i.e., 1 week after the exam of Module 3) the student will have to hand in the updated analysis, after which he/she will receive the final grade for this analysis assignment.

Method of Assessment

The knowledge and skills gained in this course will be assessed in three different ways:

1. Burden of Disease (content of week 1 and 2 lectures): an individually written exam
2. HIV in Africa case study: the written group assignments and journal club presentations
3. Quantitative Methods: An individually written exam **plus** the analysis assignment

- Burden of Disease Take Home Exam (presented in class) : 50% of the final course grade
- Group assignment in week 4: 20% of the final course grade
- Quantitative Methods: 30% of the final course grade - this consists of the written exam (70%) and the analysis assignment (30%)

Each of the three elements of assessment needs to be scored at least 5.5 for a Pass. All elements must be passed to pass the course.

Re-sits can take the form of an oral exam (at the discretion of the examiner)

Entry Requirements

Second year VU-Global Health students only.

Literature

- Merson, Black and Mills (2012): *Global Health* (3rd ed): chapters 1, 3, 5, 7.
- *Factfulness*. Rosling H., Rosling O. and Rosling Rönnlund A.
- Additional journal articles
- Quantitative methods: course material will be shared on BB.

Additional Information Target Audience

This course is only suitable for VU Global Health students.

Additional Information

Mandatory course for Global Health students

Lecturer:
dr. A.H.A. ten Asbroek (AIGHD)

Advanced Methodology ILA in Global Health

Course Code	AM_1044
Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	600
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	prof. dr. T. Zuiderent-Jerak
Examiner	prof. dr. T. Zuiderent-Jerak
Teaching Staff	L. Martinez Apraez, prof. dr. B.J. Regeer, prof. dr. T. Zuiderent-Jerak, dr. E.V. Syurina MSc
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Written partial exam, Lecture

Course Objective

The student will obtain in-depth knowledge and insights into:

- Theory on transdisciplinary research
- Different methodologies for transdisciplinary research
- When to use a transdisciplinary research approach (persistent or complex problems/many actors involved), also in comparison with other research methodologies
- Evaluation of transdisciplinary research (using quality criteria)

The student will learn to:

- Design a transdisciplinary research plan
- Independently select and combine research methods and techniques for transdisciplinary research, for example methods to analyse complex or persistent problems from different actor perspectives
- Apply advanced methods and techniques for the execution of group processes for the achievement of knowledge integration (learning): for example, focus group discussions
- Formulate recommendations for further transdisciplinary research that may contribute to the solution of Global Health issues

Course Content

Global health issues are often very complex. They can be rooted in deep organisational, political and social issues that involve many different actors, all with their own perspectives. For this reason, global health problems are often called ‘wicked’ or ‘persistent’ problems. Increasingly, the field of global health research is recognising the importance of defining these problems through the eyes of all actors involved. This implies that multiple approaches, fields of science and frames of reference are integrated to build specific, practical, experiential and scientific knowledge about the problem with those directly confronted with the problem. An interdisciplinary research approach, that aims for integrated knowledge generation is essential to do justice to the multifaceted nature of global health problems. Moreover, transdisciplinary research is distinct from mono-, multi- and interdisciplinary research. It integrates knowledge from different scientific actors with the experiential knowledge of societal actors (e.g. patients, health professionals, NGOs, government, industry, and international organisations), jointly involving scientists and societal actors in defining problems and identifying and implementing interventions through mutual learning and co- creation. Among the challenges, transdisciplinary researchers must integrate various different knowledge cultures, incorporate actors needs and feedback, all while ensuring a safe and open venue for mutual learning and co-creation.
In this course, students will be exposed to, and will practice key skills within the design and implementation of inter- and transdisciplinary research. They will acquire a grounded understanding of epistemic cultures and how knowledge value systems can challenge mutual learning. Besides executing focus group discussions, a case study format is applied to redesign a mono- or multidisciplinary research project into a transdisciplinary research project. This will ensure practical exposure to stakeholder analysis, critical stakeholder feedback, and careful stakeholder communication skills before participants design and conduct their own research in the remainder of their Masters program.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures (H - 30 hr), working groups (W - 35 hr), group work (Pro - 65 hr), self study (30 hr). Attendance at working groups is compulsory.

Method of Assessment

Assessment of the course is made up of the following parts:
Take home exam (40%) (individual)
Case study (report + presentation) (30%) (group)
FGD execution (design, facilitation, analysis) (30%) (group)
FGD facilitation individual - pass/fail
All parts have to be concluded with at least a pass grade (6).

Entry Requirements

Mandatory GH1 courses and GH1 internship

Literature

Reader with selected scientific articles (to be announced on Canvas at least a month in advance).

Additional Information Target Audience

Mandatory course for Global Health students, PhD candidates

Custom Course Registration

PhD candidates interested in taking the course, please email secretariaat.athena.beta@vu.nl

Disability and Development

Course Code	AM_470588
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. R.M.H. Peters
Examiner	dr. R.M.H. Peters
Teaching Staff	dr. R.M.H. Peters
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

- To define the concepts of 'impairment', ‘disability’ and ‘inclusive development’ using examples
- To explain the complex two-way relation between disability and poverty
- To explain the issues and barriers faced by people with disabilities in the global context
- To demonstrate with examples the importance of the UN Convention for the Rights of Persons with Disabilities and the SDG Framework for the field of disability and development
- To apply and compare relevant theories, models and frameworks related to disability (e.g. medical model, social model, ICF model, ecological system theory, twin-track approach, stigma, intersectionality, epistemic injustice).
- To design and assess studies related to disability (including participatory approaches) and interventions.
- To apply research skills during the problem-based learning sessions (e.g., participating in scientific discussions, formulating of research objectives, literature research, abstracting, summarizing and giving feedback on findings, drawing conclusions)

Course Content

The Disability and Development (D&D) course focuses on a broad range of issues related to disability in the global context. Disability affects an estimated 1.3 billion people worldwide. With trends such as aging, medical advances, population growth, shifting disease burden and the climate crises these numbers are expected to increase. About 80% of the persons with disabilities live in low and middle income countries. In countries with life expectancies over

70 years, individuals spend on average 8 years living with disabilities. Across the globe, a substantial number of people with disabilities have limited access to education, employment and health (rehabilitation) services. They also may have to deal with stigmatization, social exclusion and discrimination.

The United Nations Convention to the Rights of People with Disabilities (UNCRPD) has been crucial for the promotion of disability-inclusive development. This treaty was adopted in 2006 and has 164 signatories as of 2022. Parties that signed the convention are required to promote, protect, and ensure the full enjoyment of human rights by persons with disabilities. They also need to ensure that people with disabilities enjoy full equality under the law. Making the goals set out by the UNCRPD a reality is work in progress. Also the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) framework, with its commitment “to leave no one behind” has been crucial. The framework explicitly emphasizes including people with disabilities in terms of education, employment and research, reducing inequality, and creating inclusive communities. In 2019, heads of state and government representatives adopted the political declaration: “Universal health coverage: moving together to build a healthier world”. This declaration includes a specific reference made to persons with disabilities. In 2021 a landmark resolution was adopted by the World Health Assembly, on “The highest attainable standard of health for persons with disabilities”, which aims to advance the agenda of disability inclusion in the health sector in countries, and focuses on three central areas: i) access to effective health services; ii) protection during health emergencies; and iii) access to cross-sectorial public health interventions.

This course will cover essential knowledge and skills in the field of Disability in the Global Context.

Students are encouraged to think critically, ethically, holistically, rationally, and collegially about topics addressed in this 4 week course programme, such as:

- Epistemic Injustice
- Disability Models and other relevant theories
- Intersectionality
- Global Mental Health
- Disability and Sexuality
- Role of families
- Gender
- Violence
- Researching Disability and Stigma
- Disability Rights
- Activism
- Migration
- Child exploitation and the NGO perspective

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Problem-based learning supported by lectures.

- Lectures: 21 hours
- Tutorial groups: 21 hours
- A few optional oral exam preparation sessions
- Self-study + portfolio : remaining hours

Method of Assessment

- Oral examination (60%)
- Portfolio (30%)
- Participation in the tutorial group work (10%)
- Peer feedback (sufficient/ insufficient)

For all parts, a passing grade (> 5.5) needs to be obtained in order to successfully finish the course.

Entry Requirements

Bachelor-level education; any subject

Literature

See Canvas for suggested readings

Additional Information Target Audience

The Disability & Development module is an optional course for Master students Management, Policy Analysis and Entrepreneurship in Health and Life Sciences (MPA), Health Sciences (HS), Global Health (GH) and Biomedical Sciences (BMS).

Additional Information

For more information contact Dr. Ruth Peters (r.m.h.peters@vu.nl)

Figure It Out

Course Code	AM_1271
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	600
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. D. Brals
Examiner	dr. D. Brals
Teaching Staff	dr. A.H.A. ten Asbroek, dr. D. Brals
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

The objective of this elective course is to enhance the students' quantitative methods skills needed to design a quantitative study within a multidisciplinary context.

Upon completion the students are capable of:

- drafting a quantitative research proposal for a specific health care policy question
- applying basic and advanced quantitative data analysis methods
- summarizing the findings of the quantitative analysis
- writing a brief advisory report, based on the quantitative findings and other information that is available
- presenting the quantitative findings to an expert audience

Course Content

With the aim to advise the Health Planning Committee of a specific country: design and analyze the impact of a health intervention to decentralize diabetes and hypertension care. In this course the students will work on impact measurement of a health intervention to decentralize diabetes and hypertension care in a chosen country in a hands-on manner.

In phase 1 the students will prepare the research protocol upon request of the Ministry of Health, including a realistic budget.

In phase 2 the students will analyze a dataset that fits as much as possible their selected research approach. Part of the analysis is the identification of subgroups that show differences in impact for further qualitative research.

Finally, in phase 3 the students will triangulate the qualitative results (that will be made available) with their quantitative data to formulate policy recommendations. A written report and a presentation will complete the course.

During the first three weeks, lectures will be offered to assist students in developing a research proposal and to prepare students for their quantitative data analysis. During guided working groups, students will learn to organize, analyze, and interpret the data. In the last week the students will present their findings and policy recommendations, as well as hand in an advisory report, based on their quantitative findings and other information that is available.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures, in-class data analysis tutorials, working groups, self-study, peer review. Draft schedule:

Week 1:

- Introduction to overall scope and objectives of the course.
- Lectures on the context and concepts of the challenge at hand, understanding the call for proposals.
- Quantitative study designs.
- Lecture series on specific quantitative analysis methods.

Week 2:

- Working groups on developing the research proposal.
- Introduction to data sets.
- Working groups on quantitative data analysis.
- Lecture on budgeting of research.

Week 3:

- Working groups on collating the budget for the proposal.
- Working groups on qualitative data analysis and data triangulation.
- Mentoring the groups during final preparations.

Week 4: Write up of results and dissemination.

Method of Assessment

The course grade will be a weighted mix of the following components:

- Open book MC test (individual): 10%
- Writing assignment (individual): 15%
- Proposal (group): 20%
- R-script (individual): 10%
- Presentation (group): 20%
- Brief (group): 20%
- Engagement (individual): 5%

Entry Requirements

This elective course is open to second-year MSc Global Health (Research) students who successfully completed all courses of the first year and the first semester of the second year. First-year students with a stronger background in quantitative methods are also encouraged to participate in this course.

Literature

- R manuals.
- Case study literature will be provided.
- Other materials to be announced prior to the course.

Additional Information Target Audience

First- and second-year MSc Global Health (Research) students who want to strengthen and/or expand their quantitative research skills.

Global Health Interventions

Course Code	AM_1176
Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. N.C. Engel
Examiner	dr. N.C. Engel
Teaching Staff	dr. M.M. Waltz, dr. D. Brals, dr. N.C. Engel, dr. D.R. Essink, prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse, prof. dr. B.J. Regeer, prof. dr. T. Zuiderent-Jerak
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

At the end of this course students can:

1. understand the way global health interventions and their evaluation are deeply intertwined
2. describe the characteristics, and give examples, of successful health interventions, according to different theoretical perspectives
3. describe five study designs for studying the effect of health interventions
4. design a health intervention strategy on the basis of a case study

5. design a framework for monitoring and evaluating health interventions on the basis of a case study
6. select relevant research methods for evaluating a health intervention strategy
7. defend the health intervention strategy and framework for monitoring and evaluating its effects verbally and in written form
8. analyze differences between epistemic assumptions underlying health interventions for a similar topic

Course Content

In this course, attention is paid to the relationship between the analysis of complex health problems (needs assessment) and the design, implementation and evaluation of interventions' strategies for specific health problems. The advantages and disadvantages of various approaches to designing and evaluating global health interventions will be discussed.

In this course, students get introduced to some of the assumptions about what a good intervention and a good evaluation method is. They will be trained in epistemological thinking about interventions and evaluations, and presented with a wide range of health interventions and their evaluation methods. Research techniques, including using a transdisciplinary approach, learning histories, randomised controlled trials and cohort studies, are taught and exercised.

In the research component of the course, students work in groups to design an inter- (and where applicable trans-)disciplinary, case-based intervention strategy for a global health issue, as well as a framework for monitoring and evaluating their intervention strategy. At the end of the course, the intervention strategy is presented in front of a panel with global health experts, and reports will be critically assessed.

The most important lesson of the course is that one intervention strategy is not inherently better than the other, nor is one type of evaluation superior in nature over the other. The important skill is to reflect on how intervention and evaluation are related, and to design both in such a way that a strong contribution to the challenge at hand can be expected.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures, working groups, group work, self-study

Method of Assessment

Written take-home essay exam (50%), intervention report (group assignment) (30%) and a presentation of the assignment (20%), functioning within a group (pass/fail).
All parts have to be concluded with a grade of 5.5 or higher

Literature

An online reader will be made available on Canvas that indicates the required reading for each lecture.

Additional Information Target Audience

First-year students MSc Global Health; compulsory course. Only open to students of the Research Masters Global Health.

Additional Information

Dr. Nora Engel and guest lecturers

Global Health Master Thesis

Course Code	AM_1116
Credits	30
Period	P4+5+6
Course Level	600
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.M. Waltz
Examiner	prof. dr. T. Zuiderent-Jerak
Teaching Staff	
Teaching method(s)	

Course Objective

During the MSc Global Health (Research) thesis course, the student learns to:

- Independently design and carry out transdisciplinary research (under supervision)
- Recognise and address ethical implications of research results and their interpretation
- Hold scientific discussions in interdisciplinary teams
- Expand their personal, specialised network
- Deal with uncertainties in interdisciplinary- and transdisciplinary research
- Critically reflect on their own research and work experiences
- Orally present and defend the research in front of both a scientific and non-scientific audience

The student practices the following skills:

- Independently designing a research project (under supervision)
- Independently collecting, processing and analysing data (under supervision)
- Communicating with different stakeholders involved in the research
- Independently and responsibly working in a research organisation
- Monitoring the research quality
- Independently integrating theory and research data, which will lead to the production of a scientific article (under supervision)

Course Content

In this second research internship of the MSc Global Health (Research), a concrete transdisciplinary health problem is formulated, based on descriptive and analytical questions at different levels of aggregation (individual, group, society, system). The complexity of the health problem, combined with the use of transdisciplinary research methods, makes this internship more multifaceted as compared to the first research internship.

The student starts with a literature scan to place the specific transdisciplinary research problem in context, compare it with similar problems, and interpret it using an existing global health system model. This analysis provides the basis for the main research question as well as relevant sub-questions, and these will determine the research methodology. Quantitative and qualitative research methods are encouraged to gather data, and perspectives from multiple stakeholders must be included to meet the transdisciplinary research component. Students must collect at least some of the data analysed themselves.

The research project culminates in a research portfolio and a scientific article written in English, accompanied by a portfolio, and an oral presentation of the research results.

The full-time, five-month research project is supervised by a scientific employee from one of the three collaborating partner institutes of the MSc Global Health (Research) (VU, UvA, AIGHD/AUMC). Students will also be supported by an on-site research supervisor at the host organisation. Host organisations are typically academic or other research institutes, NGOs, government departments or healthcare organisations.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Individual supervision and or intervision (group instruction/supervision), meetings with the research team, and progress interviews. Attendance of all supervision sessions, progress interviews and the oral presentation is mandatory.

Method of Assessment

Portfolio/Article and oral presentation. All parts need to be passed (5.5) to pass the course.

Entry Requirements

Students need to have passed the exams of 18 EC of the compulsory courses of year 1 and have passed the exams of 18 EC of the compulsory courses of year 2 before they can start the Global Health Master thesis.

Literature

Appropriate literature to support methodology and method choices and practices will be provided or listed via Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

Second-year students of the MSc Global Health (Research)

Additional Information

Obligatory course for MSc Global Health (Research) students.

Global Mental Health

Course Code	AMU_0034
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.M. Waltz
Examiner	
Teaching Staff	
Teaching method(s)	

Course Objective

This is an UvA course. Please follow the link for the course description.

Course Content

https://studiegids.uva.nl/xmlpages/page/2025-2026-en/search-course/course/127794

Additional Information Teaching Methods

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Method of Assessment

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Custom Course Registration

This course is offered by the UvA. For more information contactFNWI Education Service Centre.

Enrolment via https://glass.uva.nl is required.

Governance for Global Health

Course Code	AM_1177
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. A.M.C. Loeber
Examiner	dr. A.M.C. Loeber
Teaching Staff	prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse, R.M. Spruit MSc, dr. L. Vandenbussche, dr. M.O. Kok, dr. A.M.C. Loeber, dr. D.R. Essink, ir. R. Rebernig MSc
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

The course's overall objective is to contribute to a thorough understanding among the course's participants of health governance, and of policy analysis and policy design as a dynamic process of 'puzzling' and 'powering' in view of health issues defined as social problems. After completion of this course, you will

- have demonstrated knowledge and understanding of health policy processes and their outcomes both at national and international level;
- have demonstrated knowledge and understanding of various theoretical concepts of, and approaches to governance and to the formulation, implementation and evaluation of policy in the field of public health;

- have demonstrated knowledge and understanding of the practical and ethical problems and dilemmas in navigating actors' perspectives and participation in the policy process;
- have demonstrated knowledge and understanding of, and the ability to question the role of (scientific) knowledge in policy making;
- have demonstrated competence in applying research methods, among them root-cause analysis and stakeholder analysis, useful in the context of policy formulation, implementation and evaluation;
- have demonstrated competence in practically translating a health issue into a policy problem, evaluating policies related to the issue of choice, conducting a policy analysis in view of the issue, and formulating policy recommendations that potentially may help resolve it;
- have developed your skills as critical and reflective users and producers of interdisciplinary knowledge on global health governance.

Course Content

The persistence of health issues and health-related social problems calls for due consideration of the ways in which health care is governed. How are health issues being dealt with in various countries and regions, who are co-determining the dynamics in this field in the public and private domain, with which types of institutional arrangements and resources? In this course, we look into answers to these and related questions, discussing the governance of public health issues with particular attention to national / regional differences, and to the practice of health policy making.

We will do so from a conceptual and an empirical research perspective and aspire a dedicated and fruitful interaction between the two. The theoretical component introduces concepts from the policy sciences and governance that will help you make sense of political dynamics in the development of national health systems and health policies, of agenda setting, policy implementation and the role of science in health policy, as well as of stakeholders in public health (including the private sector and organisations on the global level, such as the WHO and the World Bank), their interests and power dynamics. Practical examples are provided in the lectures to relate theoretical concepts to daily realities of health systems in different countries.

In the empirical research component of the course, which runs in parallel to the lectures, you will work in a small project group to conduct an analysis of a specific health issue of your choice and of the national health system and health policies in which it is embedded, and build on that analysis to elaborate actual policy recommendations that you can argue will result in solutions that fit the context of (inter)national health care governance that you seek to address.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures, problem-oriented analysis in working groups, 'Student-in-the-Lead' sessions, self-study

Method of Assessment

Assessment and examination will be as follows:

Individual grade:

- Exam (50%)
- Participation (including organizing a 'student-in-the-lead' session) (10%)

Group grade:

- Policy brief (40%)

All grades need to be at least 5.5 to pass the course. If you fail the exam, a resit will be arranged.

Literature

Book:

Buse, Kent, Nicholas Mays, Manuela Colombini, Alec Fraser, Mishal Khan, Helen Walls (2023).*Making Health Policy: Understanding Public Health*. Berkshire: Open University Press, 3rd edition

A selection of articles will be made available through Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

Students of the MSc Global Health (Research)

Additional Information

Compulsory course within the MSc Global Health (Research)

Health, Globalisation and Human Rights

Course Code	AM_470818
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. D.R. Essink
Examiner	dr. D.R. Essink
Teaching Staff	
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

The student;

- Is able to describe, understand and apply human rights concepts in a global context
- Develops a deeper understanding and a critical attitude towards scientific literature in the field of health, globalization and human rights in order to formulate soundly argued positions
- Is able to create his/her own vision with regard to the socio-cultural dimensions of human rights values in relation to public health
- Is able to apply methods of human rights assessment in relation to innovations in health care
- Demonstrates the ability to write and present according to academic standards

Understand and apply scenario making in the context of human rights oriented global health futures

To understand and apply (research) ethics in global health

Course Content

This course focuses on the human rights issues that are raised around the globe in connection with global health concerns. The course introduces the students to the effects of globalization on health issues, to the relevant UN human rights instruments on health and to the mechanisms to promote and protect these rights. Attention is given to a wide range of human rights topics in which health and well being play a crucial role. Examples are situations of armed conflict, reproductive rights, migration and refugee issues and children's rights. Within the context of current globalization processes the importance of local cultural insights into the human rights & global health interaction will be discussed. During the course students will prepare and participate in a scenario/simulation exercise on a human rights assessment of innovations in health technology and discuss relevant scientific literature in study groups. During the course students consistently reflect on human rights and research ethics in the context of global health. In the exam students will show their creative problem-solving skills applying them to human rights dilemmas in public health.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Contact hours

Lectures: 33 hours
Work groups: 12 hours
Group project, simulation and exam: 11 hours

Self study and preparing: remaining hours

Method of Assessment

Group projects (40%), exam (60%).
All parts need to be passed (6.0) (the exam is an essay written or oral)

Literature

Hamelink, C. J., Essink, D. R., & Visser, M. J. (Eds.). (2024). Global Health and Human Rights: Principles and Practices. Taylor & Francis.

To be announced at the start of the first work group/lecture and via Canvas for group project.

Additional Information Target Audience

Compulsory course for research master global health students. Optional course for students in all specializations of the Masters Health Sciences, Biomedical Sciences and Management, Policy Analysis and Entrepreneurship in the Health and Life Sciences.

Additional Information

For more information contact Ona Ilozumba (ona.ilozumba@vu.nl)

International Comparative Analyses of Health Care Systems

Course Code	AM_470820
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse
Examiner	prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse
Teaching Staff	K.E. Mujica Gastelbondo MSc, prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse, dr. D.R. Essink
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Written partial exam, Lecture

Course Objective

At the end of this course students are able to:

- Describe health systems, including its goals and functions, and illustrate how such systems can be analysed, compared, and reformed;
- Recognise the value of using a systems perspective and the complexity of comparing culturally diverse health systems;
- Design methodologies for comparative analyses, including the selection of countries, primary outcomes, conceptual frameworks, and indicators;
- Critically analyse and compare the health systems of two high-income countries (HICs) and two low-and middle-income countries (LMICs) on selected topics, using relevant research questions, publicly available sources, frameworks, outcomes, and qualitative and quantitative indicators;
- Differentiate between comparative health system analyses in HICs and LMICs and identify the unique challenges involved in their comparisons;
- Synthesise findings from comparative analyses in a clear and concise manner (abstracts and indicator tables);
- Perform an outlier analysis using statistical software (for MSc Global health students only);
- Develop and conduct presentations (lecture and poster presentation) about synthesised comparative results;
- Work as effective team members and collaborate with fellow students in two group assignments;
- Assess the work of your own group and those of other students and give constructive feedback.

Course Content

Until recently, the field of global health mainly embraced disease-specific initiatives and focused on the delivery of health services for specific diseases, as well as their lifestyle, environmental and socioeconomic determinants. After decades of such disease-specific initiatives, it is now recognised that programmes solely targeting the prevention or treatment of specific diseases cannot yield the desired outcomes in the context of weak health systems. Recent pandemics have emphasised the role of health systems in global situations even more. A critical determinant of health, as well as the success of global health initiatives, is the health system as a whole. Recognition of this brought ‘strengthening of health systems’ onto the global health agenda and into funding schemes.

The global health researchers and professionals of this era need to have a good understanding of health systems and the key skills to analyse and compare them in order to; adapt themselves to the different health systems in which they will work; analyse different health systems and identify how they have evolved to this point and in which areas; and determine how they can be strengthened to improve its outcomes.

Serving these purposes, this course aims to equip students with the knowledge and skills related to concepts, theory and methods on the following key areas:

- What a health system is (and different ways of describing it)
- What goals and functions health systems have
- Why and how health systems and their performance can be analysed and compared
- Why and how health systems evolve and can be reformed

In line with these, the course will cover low, middle income countries (LMICs) and high-income countries (HICs) and span across different health system goals (health gain, equity, responsiveness, and effectiveness and efficiency) and functions (stewardship, financing, resource generation, and health services).

In terms of methodology, students learn to use the case study approach for carrying out a comparative analysis. Students will be acquainted with the theory of case studies via lectures and reflection sessions and will implement this method during two group assignments. Both qualitative and quantitative aspects of ‘health systems comparison’ are discussed and critiqued. Furthermore, the complexity and culturally determined nature of health system design and health system reform are presented through a series of lectures form VU-lecturers and experts from a variety of institutions such as the Dutch Royal Tropical Institute (KIT). Case examples and what we can learn from this about (strengthening) health systems will also be discussed.

Small group work for the assignments provides opportunities to practice relevant skills by analysing, first, the health system of two selected HICs according to a defined theme (e.g. mental health, or primary care). Groups will present their findings with a lecture. Subsequently, health systems of two LMICs with comparable financial resources (e.g. GDP per capita, per capita health expenditure, etc.) but different health outputs and outcomes are analysed to find out why two countries are performing in such different ways. The findings will be presented in a poster format. By repeating the analysis on the same theme but with different countries, the students are challenged to constantly improve their own analysis process.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Teaching methods include lectures by VU teachers and guest lecturers, lectures by other students, workgroups for assignments, problem-driven learning, self-study. The total study time of 168 hours is distributed as follows:

- Lectures ~ 21hrs
- Lectures and practicals on epidemiology & statistics ~19hrs (for MSc Global Health students only)
- Workgroup meetings with coaches ~ 11hrs
- Workgroup work on assignments ~ 58hrs
- Self-study ~ 50 hrs
- Student lectures & poster presentation ~8hrs
- Exam 2,25hrs

Attendance to the workgroup meetings (including feedback sessions), students' lecture presentations and poster presentations are compulsory.

Method of Assessment

The grading of the course is based on Assignment 1, Assignment 2 and the exam:

- Assignment 1: group lecture (pass/fail)
- Assignment 2: group poster presentation (40%)
- Exam: individual assessment (60%)

Each part will be assessed over 100pts and take place on Campus. All parts need to be passed (minimum grade 5.5).

Literature

A selection of literature will be made on the basis of lectures and state of the art research. A selection of last year’s literature is listed below.

- Mills & Ranson (2012) The design of health systems.
- World Health Organisation (2011) World Health Report 2000: Health Systems: Improving Performance. (Chapter 1, Chapter 2 and the Statistical Annex)
- Yin RK. Case Study Research: Design and Methods. Sage publications 2018, London. (Chapters 1 and 2)
- World Health Organisation (2006) Working together for health
- Brito Fernandes et al. (2021) Engaging citizens in the development of a health system performance assessment framework: a case study in Ireland Health Research Policy and Systems 19:148
- Plsek PE, Greenhalgh T. Complexity science: The challenge of complexity in health care. Brit Med J. 2001;323(7313):625-8.
- Grin J & Broerse JEW (2017) Introduction. In: Broerse, J.E.W. & Grin J. (eds.) Toward Sustainable

Transitions in Healthcare Systems. New York: Routledge
- Van Raak R & de Haan FJ (2017) Key Features of Modern Health Systems: Nature and Historical Evolution. In: Broerse, J.E.W. & Grin J. (eds.) Toward Sustainable Transitions in Healthcare Systems. New York: Routledge
- Fadele KP, et al (2024) Mental health challenges in Nigeria: Bridging the gap between demand and resources. Global Mental Health, 11, e29, 1–5

Additional Information Target Audience

- Compulsory course within the Master specialisation International Public Health
- Compulsory course for 1st year Research Master Global Health students
- Optional course within the Master specialisation Infectious Diseases (master programme Biomedical Sciences).

In any other circumstances admission should be requested from the coursecoordinator.

Recommended background knowledge

It is strongly recommended that students have knowledge on public health and/or public policy in the context of health and/or care.

Materialities in Practice

Course Code	AMU_0028
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.M. Waltz
Examiner	
Teaching Staff	
Teaching method(s)	

Course Objective

This is an UvA course. Please follow the link for the course description.

Course Content

https://studiegids.uva.nl/xmlpages/page/2025-2026-en/search-course/course/127796

Additional Information Teaching Methods

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Method of Assessment

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Custom Course Registration

This course is offered by the UvA. For more information contactFNWI Education Service Centre.

Enrolment via https://glass.uva.nl is required.

Nutrition and Infectious Disease

Course Code	AM_470816
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500

Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M. van der Hoeven
Examiner	dr. M. van der Hoeven
Teaching Staff	dr. M. van der Hoeven
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Seminar, Study Group, Written partial exam, Lecture

Course Objective

The focus of this course is on the interactions between malnutrition and infection in a global context, both key concerns in vulnerable populations. This course will use examples of infections in relation to nutritional status outcomes to illustrate how:

- infection contributes to the etiology and pathogenesis of malnutrition
- malnutrition impacts the host defense mechanisms and vulnerability to infection.

This course has been designed to enable students to critically appraise literature, employ epidemiological methods and prepare students for their MSc internship. Students will use a guided self-study approach to learn the principles of nutrition and infectious diseases.

At the end of the course the student can:

- Choose and present scientifically, in depth, a biological mechanism relevant to both nutrition and infectious disease.
- Employ epidemiological methods to describe and understand risk factors related to nutrition and infectious disease.
- Develop an appropriate study design for a research question related to infectious disease and nutrition.
- Run analyses on one of the several public available datasets in order to answer the research question and to present the results.
- Answer a research question, following proper code of conduct with regards of responsible research and ethical guidelines

Course Content

The course has a strong international focus and will cover key nutritional concepts related to global trends, with a focus on the nutritional concerns of vulnerable populations. The course will focus on both epidemiology and biological pathways. The inter-relationship between infection and both under-nutrition as well as nutrition related chronic disease is of increasing importance and will be emphasized. In addition, this course helps students to prepare for the MSc Internship; the different assignments contribute to refreshing and adding to knowledge on literature appraisal, study designs, ethical considerations and research integrity, and statistical analysis. During the data analysis assignment students will be encouraged to assume the role of a public health researcher, where an one pager/abstract on the conducted research must be written.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

The focus of this full time course is on guided student learning. The first two weeks will include lectures followed by discussion groups and in-class assignments. The remainder of the course will be focused on individual as well as group projects and data analysis. Students will be expected to demonstrate an in-depth understanding of nutrition and infectious disease. Tuition methods include: • Lectures (30 hours) • Discussion groups and in-class assignments (20 hours) • Data analysis: individual and group project (70 hours) • Self-study (40 hours)

Method of Assessment

The course grade is based on presentations, peer reviews and written assignments. To pass the course, all grades have to be 5.5 or above and the peer review must be concluded with a pass.

- escape room (optional)
- written take-home assignment (35%)
- biological mechanism video presentation (10%)
- data analysis assignment (45%)
- presentation of the data analysis assignment (10%)
- peer review (pass/fail)

Entry Requirements

The admission requirements for this course are the same as for the MSc Health Sciences programme:
You will need to have at least a Bachelor’s degree from an accredited research university including at least three

full years of academic study amounting to a minimum of 180 ECTS or equivalent.

Specific admission requirements for the MSc Health Sciences programme:

1. Adequate knowledge in health and/or life sciences
2. 6 ECTS in Epidemiology
3. 12 ECTS in Biostatistics
4. 30 ECTS Biology

Literature

Course reading material will consist out of scientific articles and book chapters which will be provided on the Canvas page of Nutrition and Infectious Disease.

Additional Information Target Audience

This is a full time course in period 3 and compulsory for Infectious Diseases and Public Health specialization students. It is an optional course within the MSc programme of Health Sciences.

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Research Methods in Global Health

Course Code	AM_1175
Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. C. Meier zu Biesen
Examiner	dr. C. Meier zu Biesen
Teaching Staff	dr. C. Meier zu Biesen, dr. N.C. Engel, dr. M.M. Waltz, prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse, prof. dr. T. Zuiderent-Jerak, dr. E.V. Syurina MSc
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Seminar, Study Group, Written partial exam, Lecture

Course Objective

This is an exclusive course offered only for the first-year students of the Research Master Global Health.

1. Learning objectives for the theoretical component (as covered through lectures and Master Classes):

At the end of the course, students are able to:

- describe the relationships between diverse global health problems (well-structured versus complex problems);
- understand the main causes of the burden of disease in high-income and low- and middle-income countries;
- describe border-crossing health problems from the perspective of different disciplines (biomedical sciences, epidemiology, health sciences, health economics, anthropology);
- understand the indicators and describe the main issues in sub-fields such as maternal health, migrant health and mental ill health;
- understand cross-cultural aspects of health and health research.

2. Learning objectives for the research component (as covered through lectures, workshops and assignment):

At the end of the course, students are able to:

- describe the advantages and limitations of various research approaches (monodisciplinary, multidisciplinary, interdisciplinary and transdisciplinary);
- describe theory creation in transdisciplinary research (epistemology and methodology, including criteria for scientific quality);
- describe basic methods and techniques (epidemiology, statistics, scoping literature review, observation, interviews, surveys/questionnaires, focus group discussions) and methods (quantitative, qualitative, mixed-methods) for analysing complex health problems;
- design an interdisciplinary or transdisciplinary needs assessment in relation to a global health problem;

- prove good academic writing skills by writing a scientific report;
- communicate a scientific message to an academic audience;
- work as a valued team member in a project team;
- provide and receive feedback from peers and supervisors.

Course Content

This course highlights the increasing complexity of health problems in a global context, and builds the case for using multidisciplinary, interdisciplinary and transdisciplinary research approaches as a way to offer valuable insights into complex health problems and to create a broad acceptance of solutions among stakeholders.

The course consists of complementary theoretical and research components.

The theoretical component of the course consists of lectures and Master Classes. During the lectures, students become acquainted with current topics in global health, which are placed in a historical perspective. During the Master Classes, experts from several fields of global health illustrate the complexity of the disease burden in a global context, and build the case for multi-, inter- and transdisciplinary analysis of complex problems. Master Classes typically consist of two sessions. The first session is organized as a lecture, in which the topic is approached from inter- and transdisciplinary perspectives. The second session is organized as a supervised workgroup, in which students discuss the most recent developments as published in the literature, and thus become familiar with the different paradigms and models used in global health.

The research component of the course consists of lectures, workshops and group Problem Analysis assignment (Assignment I), as well as reflection on global health topic of your choice and your growing competences as a Global Health researcher (Assignment II). During the lectures and workshops, students acquire basic knowledge and skills on research design, different research paradigms, quantitative and qualitative research methods, and the combination thereof (including activities such as participating in a focus discussion group and reflecting on their experience, and using mixed-methods approaches).

For the Problem Analysis assignment, students design a research proposal to address a specific, real-world global health issue provided by a commissioning partner (agency, NGO or academic researcher). The design of the proposal is based on a literature review and interviews with relevant stakeholders (for example, an NGO representative and academic). The assignment is conducted in groups. Each group receives feedback from coaches on different versions of their draft reports during the supervised working group sessions, and each group provides feedback to another group in one peer review round. Additional feedback will be received when findings are presented.

This course incorporates the first stages of two tracks that will then continue on through subsequent courses: quantitative research training led by staff from course partner AIGHD/AUMC, and a personal and professional development track focused on development of skills, aptitudes and attitudes required to work effectively in a multicultural research world. Quantitative research skills are assessed with an Exam, which takes place during the subsequent course (Global Health Interventions).

Additional Information Teaching Methods

- Lectures and workshops (~70 hrs)
- Workgroups (assignment and portfolio) (~50 hrs)
- Self-study (~80 hrs)

Method of Assessment

Assignment 1 (group project): Problem Analysis Statement - written report: pass/fail
Assignment 2 (45%): Reflective essay on a chosen global health topic, to include two possible research approaches and the rationales behind choosing them, and reflection on the student researcher's own positionality: numerical grade
Note: in preparation for Assignment 2, students hand in two reflections on lectures or Masters Classes, in Week 2 and Week 3.

Oral presentation/pitch of Problem Analysis Statement (15%): numerical grade*
Quantitative research methods exam (40%): numerical grade **

A pass (5.5) or Pass in case of pass/fail elements is required for each of these assessments to pass the course.

* The oral presentation/pitch of the PAS occurs in early October, as it informs the connected next group project in the next course.
** The quantitative research methods exam for this course reflects the content of a quantitative research track that runs across the first two courses of the MSc Global Health, and therefore occurs in October.

Literature

- Creswell, J.W. and Creswell, J.D. (2013) Research Design: Qualitative, Quantitative, and Mixed Methods Approaches. Sage.
- Gray, D.E. (2013). *Doing Research in the Real World*. London: Sage.
- Diez, D. et al. (2014) Introductory Statistics with Randomization and Simulation - First Edition.
- Free PDF available through www.openintro.org
- Selected articles relevant to the course are provided or listed via Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

Exclusively for first-year students in the Research Master Global Health
(not open for other Masters students)

Additional Information

Compulsory course for MSc Global Health (Research)

Explanation Canvas

Canvas is used to provide an expanded study guide, readings and additional information.

Recommended background knowledge

Basic understanding of statistics and epidemiology is an admissions requirement for MSc Global Health (Research), but can be compensated for by completing (online) courses *before* starting programme.

Research Project Global Health

Course Code	AM_1102
Credits	30
Period	P4+5+6
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	Dutch
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.M. Waltz
Examiner	prof. dr. T. Zuiderent-Jerak
Teaching Staff	
Teaching method(s)	

Course Objective

The student learns

- To independently prepare a transdisciplinary research design and develop this into a research proposal (under supervision)
- To execute collection of published evidence on the topic (literature review)
- To independently collect, process and analyse research data (under supervision)
- To integrate former knowledge and skills into the research
- To work independently and responsibly in a research organisation
- To independently integrate theory and research data, and to develop this into a research report (under supervision)
- To critically reflect on their own working methods and experiences
- To monitor the quality of the research
- To deal with uncertainties
- To present the research orally and defend it before a scientific public

Course Content

In this first Global Health research internship, a concrete problem will be structured based on descriptive (what is it about?) and analytical (what is the underlying cause?) questions. In this analysis, a distinction is made between different levels of aggregation (individual, group, society, system), and appropriate monodisciplinary and transdisciplinary research methods are employed.

The student starts with a scan of the literature to place the specific problem in context relative to comparable problems, and to interpret it by means of existing global health system models. This provides the basis for the main question and relevant sub-questions, and will determine the research methodology. Students are required to use a

mixed-methods approach, in which both qualitative and quantitative data are analysed. At least some of this data must be collected by the student. Appropriate data collection and analysis methods are chosen based on the research aims, participants and setting.

The research project lasts five months, and is carried out on a full-time basis under the guidance of an academic supervisor who is a scientific employee from one of the three collaborating partners of the MSc Global Health course (VU, UvA, AIGHD/AUMC). In addition, the student will have a PhD-qualified on-site research supervisor within the host organisation. Host organisations are typically academic or other research institutes, NGOs, government departments or healthcare institutions.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

In addition to self-study via individual research (background research, discussions with on-site supervisor and colleagues, etc.), teaching methods include individual supervision and/or intervision (group instruction/supervision), meetings with the research team, and progress interviews. Attendance is mandatory for all supervision sessions, all progress interviews, and the presentation.

Method of Assessment

Written report and oral presentation. All parts need to be passed (5.5) to pass the course.

Entry Requirements

Students need to have passed the exams and practical exercises of 18 EC of the courses of Year 1 of the MSc Global Health (Research) before they can start the Research Project Global Health course.

Literature

Applicable literature to support research method choice and use will be provided or listed on the course Canvas page.

Additional Information Target Audience

First-year students MSc Global Health (Research)

Additional Information

Obligatory component of the MSc Global Health (Research) programme

Sex, Reproduction and Development

Course Code	AMU_0029
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.M. Waltz
Examiner	
Teaching Staff	
Teaching method(s)	

Course Objective

This is an UvA course. Please follow the link for the course description.

Course Content

https://studiegids.uva.nl/xmlpages/page/2024-2025-en/search-course/course/117352

Additional Information Teaching Methods

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Method of Assessment

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Custom Course Registration

This course is offered by the UvA. For more information contactFNWI Education Service Centre.

Enrolment via https://glass.uva.nl is required.